

Digital Literacy Report

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Branch - Cse core

Year - 2026

Course Code - CSE0001

Introduction

In today's world, we use the internet almost every day for studying, communication, and payments. Because of this, it has become really important to understand how to use digital tools safely and responsibly. This project is based on improving digital literacy and becoming more aware of online safety.

Through this project, I worked on different activities like creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, practising coding, and using online tools for collaboration. These tasks helped me understand how digital platforms can be useful in both academics and future careers.

One important scenario included in this project is online payment fraud, where people are tricked into sending money or sharing private details. This shows how a small mistake online can lead to big problems, and why being careful is so important.

TASK 1

For creating the infographic, I used Canva because it is easy to use and provides ready-made templates, icons, and design elements. It helped me organize my content neatly and make the infographic visually appealing.

I also used a web browser to search for important and reliable information about digital safety and cybercrime awareness.

Creation Process:

First, I collected information about online safety, including topics like strong passwords, phishing, and UPI fraud. I made sure to choose points that are important and easy for students to understand.

Then, I selected a simple infographic template in Canva and started adding the content. I divided the information into sections like general safety tips, financial safety, and reporting cybercrime. I used icons and colors to make the design more attractive and easy to read.

After completing the design, I checked for any mistakes and made small improvements. Finally, I downloaded the infographic in a proper format.

Challenges Faced:

The main challenge was keeping the information short while still including all important points. I also had to make sure the design was not too crowded.

Learning Outcome:

This task helped me improve my creativity and taught me how to present information in a simple and clear way. I also learned more about online safety and how important it is in daily life.

TASK 2-

Platforms Chosen:

For this task, I created my digital portfolio using LinkedIn and GitHub.

About the Platforms:

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where users can create profiles, showcase their skills, connect with professionals, and explore job or internship opportunities. It is widely used by students and working professionals to build their professional identity.

GitHub is a platform mainly used by developers to store, manage, and share their coding projects. It allows users to upload projects (repositories), track changes, and collaborate with others.

Purpose of Choosing These Platforms:

I chose LinkedIn because it helps in building a professional image and connecting with people from different industries. It is useful for exploring internships and career opportunities.

I chose GitHub because it allows me to showcase my coding skills and projects. It acts as a portfolio where others can see my work and progress.

How I Plan to Use Them in the Future:

In the future, I plan to regularly update my LinkedIn profile by adding my skills, certifications, and achievements. I will also connect with professionals and

follow companies to stay updated about opportunities.

For GitHub, I will continue uploading my projects and improving them over time. I will try to learn new technologies and showcase them through my repositories. This will help me build a strong technical profile.

Learning Outcome:

This task helped me understand the importance of having a professional online presence. I learned how these platforms can be used not just for learning but also for career growth.

TASK 3-

Platforms Used:

For this task, I used HackerRank for coding practice and Google Forms for collaboration and data collection.

What I Practiced and Built:

On HackerRank, I practiced basic programming problems such as printing output, using conditional statements, and writing loops. These exercises helped me understand the logic behind coding and improved my problem-solving skills.

Using Google Forms, I created a survey related to students' online habits and digital awareness. I designed questions, shared the form, and collected responses. After that, I reviewed the responses to understand common patterns and awareness levels among students.

How These Tools Help Me in Academics:

HackerRank helps me strengthen my programming skills, which is important for my academic subjects related to computer science. It improves my logical thinking and prepares me for coding exams and assignments.

Google Forms helps in conducting surveys and collecting data easily. It is useful for projects, research work, and group activities. It also helps in organizing information and analyzing responses quickly.

Learning Outcome:

Through this task, I learned how to use online platforms for both coding and collaboration. It improved my technical skills as well as my ability to collect and analyze data. These tools will be very helpful for my academic growth and future projects.

TASK 4-

Poor communication can often lead to misunderstandings and problems. One such situation happened during a group project in college. Our team had to submit an assignment, but one member misunderstood the deadline due to unclear communication in our group chat. As a result, their part was not completed on time, which delayed the entire submission.

The main issue was that the instructions were not clearly discussed, and no one confirmed the deadline properly. Everyone assumed that others had understood it correctly.

This problem could have been avoided if we had communicated more clearly. We should have confirmed the deadline in one place, like a shared document or message, and ensured that every member acknowledged it. Regular follow-ups and proper coordination would have helped prevent confusion.

This experience taught me that clear and direct communication is very important in teamwork to avoid unnecessary mistakes and delays.

TASK 5-

UPI fraud is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick users into sending money or revealing sensitive banking information. It has become very common due to the widespread use of digital payment apps.

A typical case happens step-by-step like this: First, the fraudster contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, delivery agent, or customer care representative. Next, they create urgency by saying there is a problem with the account or a pending reward. Then, they send a payment request, link, or QR code and ask the user to approve it or enter their OTP. Once the user follows these instructions, money gets transferred from their account.

Students, elderly people, and those who are not very familiar with online payments are usually targeted because they may trust such messages easily.

The consequences include financial loss, stress, and fear of using digital platforms again. In some cases, victims may also face delays in recovering their money.

For example, a student received a call about a fake cashback offer and ended up losing money after approving a request. This shows how easily such fraud can happen if one is not careful.

To stay safe, users should never share OTPs, avoid unknown links, and always verify payment requests.

Task 5 - Part B

While researching UPI and online payment fraud, what surprised me the most was how easily people get trapped, even when they are educated and aware. I realized that fraudsters don't just rely on technical tricks but mainly use psychological pressure like urgency, fear, or attractive offers to manipulate people. This made me understand that anyone can become a victim if they are not careful in the moment.

One thing that really stood out to me was how a simple action, like approving a payment request without checking, can lead to immediate financial loss. Many victims actually make mistakes because they panic or trust the caller.

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is that I will always double-check every payment request and never act in a hurry. I will also avoid responding to unknown calls or messages related to banking or money.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in today's world. Through different tasks, I learned how to stay safe online, identify cyber threats, and use digital platforms responsibly. I also gained practical knowledge about tools like Canva, LinkedIn, GitHub, HackerRank, and Google Forms, which are useful for both academic and professional purposes.

One of the most important learnings from this project is that being aware and careful online can prevent many cybercrimes. I also understood the value of clear communication, teamwork, and maintaining a professional digital presence.

Overall, this project improved my technical skills, creativity, and awareness about online safety. It has prepared me to use digital technologies more effectively and responsibly in my academic journey and future career.